

Title

Long-term functional and psychological impacts of structured nursing support in inflammatory bowel disease: secondary outcomes and subgroup analysis from a randomized controlled trial

Abstract

While primary disease-control metrics are important, patient-reported functional status, mental health, and treatment satisfaction define comprehensive IBD management success. We report secondary analyses from a 52-week randomized trial of 98 IBD patients allocated to intensive nursing support (n=50) or standard management (n=48). Secondary measures evaluated sustained remission rates, durability of treatment response, patient satisfaction with care coordination, functional limitations in work and daily activities, and psychological well-being scores. By 52-week follow-up, a substantially higher proportion of intensive-contact participants achieved and sustained disease remission. Patients receiving intensive nursing support reported greater satisfaction with their care experience and reported fewer activity limitations affecting employment and leisure. Subgroup analyses suggested consistent benefits across disease phenotypes and baseline disease severity. Qualitative exit interviews highlighted structured accountability and regular provider contact as key satisfaction drivers. These secondary findings extend primary-outcome data, demonstrating that systematic nursing engagement produces benefits beyond immediate disease control to encompass functional and psychological dimensions of patient health.